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Community Project for F.Y. B.Tech. Students

NEP 2020 and Community Engagement:

The National Education Policy (NEP) announced by the Government of India in 2020 has presented a transformative framework for higher education in the country. It reinforces that “The purpose of the education system is to develop good human being capable of rational thought and action, possessing compassion and empathy, courage and resilience, scientific temper, and creative imagination, with sound ethical moorings and values. It aims at producing engaged, productive, and contributing citizens for building an equitable, inclusive, and plural society as envisaged by our Constitution (pg 5)”.

According to NEP 2020, the goals of ‘fostering social responsibility and community engagement in HEIs’ are:

- Improving the quality of teaching/learning in HEIs, by bridging the gap between theory and practice through community engagement.
- Promoting deeper interactions between higher educational institutions and local communities for identification and solution of real-life problems faced by the communities in a spirit of mutual benefit.
- Facilitating partnerships between local communities and institutions of higher education so that students and teachers can learn from local knowledge and wisdom.
- Engaging higher education institutions with local communities in order to make curriculum, courses and pedagogies more appropriate to achieving the goals of national development.
- Catalysing acquisition of values of public service and active citizenship amongst students and youth alike, which would also encourage, nurture and harness the natural idealism of youth.
- Undertaking research projects in partnership with local community through community-based research methods.

Introduction:

Community projects provide engineering students with invaluable opportunities to translate theoretical knowledge into practical solutions. These real-world experiences nurture creativity, enhance problem-solving abilities, and cultivate a strong sense of social responsibility. Participation in such projects not only contributes to community welfare but also significantly enriches students' educational journeys.

This document offers a comprehensive overview of a community project designed specifically for engineering students, outlining its core objectives, implementation strategies, and anticipated impact.

At the heart of these initiatives lies the application of engineering principles to address tangible challenges faced by local communities. The goal is to improve quality of life, support sustainable development, and promote social inclusion. Through active participation, students gain hands-on experience, deepen their empathy, and emerge as engaged and socially conscious engineers poised to make meaningful contributions to society.

Objectives of the Project:

The primary objectives of the community project are:

- To raise awareness among students about the living conditions and challenges faced by people in their surrounding communities.
- To expose students to the realities of society, fostering a deeper understanding of socio-economic disparities.
- To encourage attitudinal transformation, nurturing societal consciousness, empathy, responsibility, and accountability.
- To empower students to explore their inner potential, enabling them to develop innovative and unconventional solutions to social problems.
- To cultivate socially responsible citizenship, sensitizing students to the needs of marginalized and disadvantaged groups.
- To promote active civic engagement, encouraging students to collaborate with public institutions and government authorities in initiating community development activities.
- To foster a holistic perspective on life by engaging students in the study of local culture, traditions, lifestyles, resource utilization, waste management, public administration, and the functioning of various social systems.

Outcomes of the Project:

Upon completion of the community project, students shall be able to:

- Understand the challenges faced by vulnerable and marginalized sections of society, gaining insight into their struggles and needs.
- Initiate and participate in collaborative team efforts aimed at driving positive societal change.
- Develop familiarity with the dynamics of urban and/or rural communities, deepening their awareness of local socio-cultural and economic contexts.
- Actively contribute to community development efforts, applying their skills and knowledge in meaningful ways.
- Design and implement activities tailored to specific target groups, based on their unique needs and circumstances.
- Recognize the importance of structured program implementation as a means to effectively transform communities and address social issues.
- Greater sense of personal efficacy, personal integrity, and moral development.
- Greater interpersonal development, particularly the ability to work well with others, and build leadership and communication skills.
- Reduced stereotypes and greater inter-cultural understanding.
- Improved social responsibility and citizenship skills.
- Greater involvement in community service after graduation.

General Guidelines to Students/Groups:

The primary aim of this community project is not only to deepen your awareness of the people and environment around you but also to help you grow into a more empathetic and socially responsible individual. Engaging in such service is highly valued by many employers and can significantly enhance your resume, especially for roles that prioritize civic engagement and leadership. Therefore, your full commitment and sincere participation are expected throughout the project.

You are expected to adhere to the following guidelines during the execution of your project:

- Each group shall consist of 6-12 members. Groups will be formed based on residential proximity to facilitate coordination and ease of project execution.
- The project will be evaluated in the first week of the third semester. You are expected to complete the project and submit the report within the specified timeframe. Grading

will be based on an absolute grading, emphasizing the quality and impact of your work.

- Your report and presentation should have **geo-tagged photographs, short clippings of the interaction/meeting with the community members.**
- Clearly outline the objectives, goals, and expected outcomes of the project. Ensure that these are achievable within the given timeframe and resources available.
- Delegate tasks among group members based on their strengths, skills, and interests. Make sure everyone understands their role and what is expected of them.
- Set up regular meetings to discuss progress, challenges, and next steps. Utilize communication tools such as emails, messaging apps, or project management platforms to keep everyone informed and connected.
- Develop a timeline with key milestones and deadlines to track progress and ensure that the project stays on schedule. Allow some flexibility for unexpected delays or issues.
- Manage resources such as time, budget, and materials effectively. Prioritize tasks based on their importance and allocate resources accordingly. Ensure equitable distribution of resources among group members.
- The institute shall not bear any costs associated with the project.
- Encourage open communication, cooperation, and mutual support among group members. Foster a positive and inclusive team environment where everyone feels valued and respected.
- Maintain quality standards throughout the project. Regularly review progress and provide feedback to ensure that the project meets its objectives.
- Conduct the project with integrity and respect for ethical principles. Ensure that all activities comply with relevant laws, regulations, and ethical standards.
- Address conflicts or disagreements within the team promptly and constructively. Encourage dialogue and find mutually acceptable solutions.
- Involve the community in the project whenever possible. Seek feedback, input, and support from stakeholders to ensure the project's success and relevance.
- Keep detailed records of project activities, including meeting minutes, progress reports, and any relevant documentation. Share updates with stakeholders, such as community members or project sponsors, to maintain transparency and accountability.

Evaluation Methodology:

The total mark for the project is 100 and the number of credits assigned is 2.

The weightings of the assessment shall be:

Identification of Problem/Project: 20 marks

Project Implementation: 20 marks

Logbook: 20 marks

Project report: 20 marks

Presentation: 20 marks

Identification of Problem/Project: 20 marks

You are expected to identify real problems, concerns or issues that are actually relevant in the area you are working on during the project. The identified problem should reflect an original effort to understand and engage with a real community need, not merely replicate common examples. While identifying the problem, engage local community members through surveys, interviews, or meetings to gather first-hand insights and ensure the identified problem is relevant and significant to the people it is concerned with. Avoid vague or overly broad issues. Consider whether the problem can be addressed through a realistic, manageable project given the available resources, time, and skills. Prefer problems that allow for long-term solutions or benefits, rather than temporary or superficial fixes.

Ensure that the problem aligns with the values, mission, or educational goals of our institution.

Assessment will consider how deeply the problem has been analyzed, including root causes, impact, and the context within which it exists.

Projects must demonstrate that community members or stakeholders were consulted, and their perspectives considered in identifying the problem. You must follow ethical practices while interacting with the community, including informed consent, confidentiality, and respect for local customs, beliefs and norms.

Project Implementation: 20 marks

The implementation of the project should align strictly with the identified problem for the project. All relevant stakeholders must be consulted and actively involved throughout the implementation to ensure inclusivity and sustainability. Financial, material, and human resources must be used wisely and transparently. Regular progress updates must be communicated to the respective faculty coordinator/s to maintain transparency and accountability. A detailed record of activities, challenges, decisions, and lessons learned

should be maintained for reference, transparency, and future use. The implementation process should include opportunities for skill development and capacity building among community members.

The assessment of the **Community Project implementation** shall include the following components and will be based on the entries of Project Logbook and Project Report:

- a. Orientation to the community development
- b. Conducting a baseline assessment of development needs
- c. Number and Quality of Awareness Programmes organised on beneficiary programmes and improvement in quality of life, environment and social consciousness, motivation and leadership, personality development, etc.
- d. Number and Quality of Intervention Programmes (Prevention or promotion programs that aim to promote behavioural change in defined community contexts to address social problems) organized.
- e. Follow-up Programmes suggested (Referral Services, Bringing Community Participation)
- f. Developing short and mid-term action plans in consultation with local leadership and local government officers.

Logbook: 20 marks

Each student is required to maintain an individual logbook, where he/she is supposed to record day-to-day activities/involvement. The project log is assessed on an individual basis. The assessment will take into consideration the individual student's involvement in the assigned work.

While grading the students' performance, using the student's project log, the following shall be considered:

- a. The individual student's effort and commitment
- b. The originality and quality of the work produced by the individual student
- c. Students' integration and co-operation with the work assigned
- d. The completeness of the logbook

Project Report: 20 marks

The **Project Report** shall be prepared as per the guidelines given below:

1. Introduction to the project.
2. About the Village / Habitation.
3. Socio-Economic Survey of the Village/Habitation.

4. Data collection using prescribed formats.
5. Problems identified and Analysis of the problems.
6. Project implementation in detail.
7. Short-term and long-term action plan for possible solutions for the problems identified and that could be recommended to the concerned authorities for implementation.
8. Community awareness programmes conducted with respect to the problems and their outcomes.
9. A mini-project work in the related subject with reference to the habitation/village.
10. Recommendations and conclusions

Project Presentation: 20 marks

The **Project Presentation** is to be made and presented before the evaluator. The components for presentation assessment shall be:

- a. Assessing the total involvement in the project.
- b. Presentation skills.
- c. Outcome of the project as evidenced by the student.

Timeline and Submission:

All reports, logbooks, presentations, and supporting documentation must be submitted by the specified deadline. Late submissions may result in grade deductions unless prior approval for an extension has been granted.

Suggested Projects:

These are only a few foundational suggestions to guide the implementation of your community project. You are expected to assess and address issues that are particularly relevant to the area where the project is being undertaken.

1. Water facilities and drinking water availability
2. Health intervention programmes
3. Traditional health care methods
4. Dispute resolution systems
5. Commercial crops
6. Buying motives
7. Usage of cell phones
8. Self-employed professionals
9. Entrepreneurship

10. Agricultural products and marketing
11. Poultry business
12. Dairy business
13. Aquaculture
14. Village industry products and marketing
15. Public distribution system
16. Online purchases
17. Digital transactions
18. Use of electrical home appliances
19. Use of electronic home appliances
20. Consumer movement
21. Youth engagement
22. Women empowerment
23. Women education
24. Status of socially deprived sections
25. Social inclusiveness
26. Safety and security
27. Infrastructure development
28. Career orientation of youth
29. Skill development programmes and their impact
30. Environmental protection
31. Soil protection
32. Renewable energy
33. Use of chemicals on fruits and vegetables
34. Organic farming
35. Access to safe drinking water
36. Geographical survey
37. Geological survey
38. Sericulture
39. Food adulteration
40. Incidence of Diabetes and other chronic diseases
41. Human genetics
42. Blood groups and blood picture

Projects for School Children:

1. Reading Skill Programme (Reading Competition)
2. Preparation of Study Materials for the next class
3. Personality / Leadership Development
4. Career Guidance for X class students
5. Screening Documentary and other educational films
6. Awareness Programme on Good Touch and Bad Touch (Sexual abuse)
7. Awareness Programme on Socially relevant themes

Projects for Women Empowerment:

1. Government Guidelines and Policy Guidelines
2. Women's Rights
3. Domestic Violence
4. Prevention and Control of Cancer
5. Promotion of Social Entrepreneurship
